

Working Holiday Visas for Indians — Australia & New Zealand

The current position — verified from official government sources on 2 July 2026

The short answer first: Yes, a working holiday route for Indians now exists for Australia — but its yearly window is currently CLOSED. New Zealand's has been announced but is NOT open yet. So right now, there is nothing you can apply for today in either country — and anyone charging you to 'apply now' or 'reserve a spot' is selling something that does not exist.

Australia — Work and Holiday visa (Subclass 462)

Status: India IS eligible (since 2024) — but the 2026–27 ballot window is now **CLOSED**.

This is a real visa route for young Indians, and it is separate from the MATES graduate scheme. It lets Indians aged 18–30 live, work, and travel in Australia for up to 12 months. There are only **1,000 places per program year**, and access is by a random pre-application ballot.

What happened in 2026 (so you know the cycle)

1. The 2026–27 ballot registration ran 4 June to 25 June 2026 — now closed.
2. Registration cost AUD 25 (non-refundable), paid to the Department of Home Affairs via ImmiAccount.
3. Random selections are drawn between 2 July 2026 and 30 April 2027.
4. If selected, you get 28 days to lodge the full visa application and pay the visa fee (approx. AUD 650).

What this means for you now: if you did not register in the June 2026 window, you cannot apply for this year. The next registration window is expected around June 2027 — watch the official page below and register yourself when it opens.

Eligibility to prepare for the next window

- ☐ Indian citizen aged 18 to 30 at time of application, holding a valid passport
- ☐ Hold a valid PAN card (specifically required for India)
- ☐ Meet the education requirement (completed Year 12 / tertiary study — check the current standard)
- ☐ Functional English (e.g. IELTS or equivalent, per the official requirement)
- ☐ Enough personal savings to support yourself on arrival
- ☐ No dependent children accompanying you

Official page (register here when it reopens): immi.homeaffairs.gov.au → Work and Holiday visa (subclass 462) → Ballot

New Zealand — Working Holiday Visa for India

Status: Announced under the India–NZ Free Trade Agreement, but **NOT OPEN YET**.

The India–New Zealand FTA (signed April 2026) commits New Zealand to offering **1,000 Working Holiday Visas per year** to Indian citizens aged 18–30, for up to 12 months. This is genuinely new and genuinely coming — but as of today there is no live application process.

Where it actually stands

- ☐ The FTA is signed; the working-holiday scheme is part of it
- ☐ Visa rules are still being finalized — a working scheme is expected mid-to-late 2026 at the earliest
- ☐ Only 1,000 places a year means it will be competitive once it opens
- ☐ There is currently NO form, portal, or fee — nothing to apply for today

Official source to watch: immigration.govt.nz

The scam this situation creates

Because the New Zealand scheme is announced but not open, it is the perfect setup for fraud. If anyone is currently offering to:

- X “register you early” or “reserve your spot” for the NZ working holiday visa
- X “guarantee selection” before the scheme has even launched
- X take a fee now “to be first in the queue”

...they are selling a queue that does not exist. There is no early list. When New Zealand opens the scheme, it will be announced on immigration.govt.nz, and you will be able to apply yourself.

Quick comparison

Australia — Subclass 462

- ☐ Real, India-eligible, 1,000 places/year — but this year's ballot window has closed
- ☐ Next likely registration: around June 2027
- ☐ Action now: prepare your PAN card, passport, savings, and English — then register yourself when it reopens

New Zealand — Working Holiday

- ☐ Real and coming (1,000 places/year under the FTA) — but not open yet
- ☐ Likely launch: mid-to-late 2026
- ☐ Action now: only watch immigration.govt.nz — do NOT pay anyone to 'pre-register'

Also not real for Indians (so you're not misled)

Two things are frequently mis-sold to Indian applicants:

- X “Australia/NZ seasonal work visa ballots” — Australia's PALM and New Zealand's RSE seasonal schemes are for specific Pacific Island nations and Timor-Leste. Neither includes India.
- X The Australian Subclass 417 Working Holiday visa — India is NOT on its list. Indians use Subclass 462 (above), not 417. If an agent offers you '417 for India', that is a red flag.

Confused, or been quoted a price for any of this? Ask us first — free.

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Sources: Australian Department of Home Affairs (Work and Holiday visa subclass 462 ballot), Immigration New Zealand, and the India–New Zealand FTA announcements. Verified 2 July 2026. Dates, fees and rules change — always confirm on the official government pages above before acting. RouteUp is not affiliated with any government. This document is free; if anyone sold it to you, that is a red flag.